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“There were at least 20 other companies in the food delivery business with great technology. But what matters are the real things like the ability build scale or just moving fast”



Rahul Bothra

CFO, SWIGGY

“We are a platform business... It is necessary to look at us differently, and a key factor is how consumer engagement drives sustainable competitive advantage”

things, like the ability to build scale or just moving fast enough.” To keep it simple, the approach has always been to put oneself in the customer’s shoes. “In food delivery, there was an issue of minimum orders, or in quick commerce, it came about after next-day grocery delivery was the norm.”

In markets across the world, the food delivery landscape is dominated by two or three players. There’s

THE RACE FOR BLACK

- 1 In the delivery market, Swiggy trails rival Zomato
- 2 India is still at a nascent stage for both food delivery and quick commerce
- 3 In quick commerce, Swiggy is up against Zomato’s Blinkit and Zepto
- 4 The real value for Swiggy’s investors will come from quick commerce

Bloisi is visibly excited about Swiggy’s foray into quick commerce through Instamart. “It has been a pioneer in quick commerce, seizing the opportunity that comes from a large user base to expand beyond its core business. Swiggy’s agility comes from its willingness to experiment, bring ideas to the market quickly, and adapt or pivot in a rapidly evolving consumer ecosystem.”

THE PLATFORM

In a business so driven by technology, getting the right differentiator is hugely critical. Reddy, who is also Head of Innovation, speaks candidly of at least 20 other companies in food delivery businesses with great technology. “But what matters are the real

a reason for that. “One is dealing with restaurant partners, delivery partners, and customers. All three have to be satisfied with 100% accuracy all the time on crores of orders across 700 cities,” says Rohit Kapoor, Swiggy’s CEO of Food Marketplace. With a grin, he adds, “This business is not for the faint-hearted, and execution is key.”

Soon after its listing, Swiggy launched Bolt, a service that delivers food in 10 minutes. Swiggy is a complex entity, and as its CHRO, Girish Menon, puts it, “We are many companies in one, given the varied nature of businesses. In reality, it has brick and mortar, FMCG, and tech.”

Perhaps that is one of the reasons why investors may find it hard to grasp the nuances of a business like this.